CHIARA GARDENGHI

NYU Stern School of Business, Dept. of Economics
Kaufman Management Center, 44 West 4th Street, New York, NY 10012
cg3454@stern.nyu.edu   chiaragardenghi.com

Appointments

Rochester Simon Business School
Postdoctoral Associate — 2025 - present

Education

New York University, Stern School of Business
Ph.D. in Economics — 2019 - 2025

Bocconi University
M.Sc. in Economics (ESS), *110/110 Cum Laude* — 2016 - 2018

Bocconi University
B.Sc. in Economics (CLES), *110/110 Cum Laude* — 2013 - 2016

References

Prof. Michael J. Dickstein
Dept. of Economics
NYU Stern School of Business
michael.dickstein@nyu.edu

Prof. Christopher Conlon
Dept. of Economics
NYU Stern School of Business
cconlon@stern.nyu.edu

Prof. Luís Cabral
Dept. of Economics
NYU Stern School of Business
luis.cabral@nyu.edu

Research Fields

Industrial Organization, Health Economics, Applied Microeconomics

Working Papers

"Bundled Loyalty Discounts in Healthcare: Evidence from Physician-Administered Vaccines"
(Job Market Paper)

In many industries, multi-product sellers offer bundled loyalty discounts to buyers who refrain from purchasing competing products from rivals. These contracts can increase sales volumes by helping sellers establish a strong customer base across their product portfolios, but they also risk foreclosing competing sellers, even those offering superior products. I examine the welfare implications of bundled loyalty discounts in the context of physician-administered vaccines, which medical providers purchase and administer directly to their patients. I use prior antitrust cases involving vaccines to recover the proprietary terms of bundled discount contracts. I then develop a model of medical providers' demand and pharmaceutical companies' supply of vaccines. Using all-payer claims data from Colorado to estimate the model, I recover medical providers' preferences, vaccines' marginal costs, and the magnitude of bundled discounts that rationalizes providers' observed purchasing patterns. I use the model to evaluate the equilibrium and welfare effects of banning bundled discounts, allowing sellers and buyers to re-optimize their choices. I show that, in the absence of discounts, providers purchase fewer and lower-quality products, particularly at the expense of optional vaccines not required for school access. Insurers benefit in the short term through lower immunization coverage costs. The effect on pharmaceutical companies varies, depending on the scope and composition of their vaccine portfolios.

“Healthcare Innovation Across the Racial Divide: The Interplay of Public and Private Financing”
(Under Submission—with L. Cabral, D. Hegde and J. Lin)

Are the private and public sectors substitutes or complements in promoting biomedical innovation? We explore the key economic drivers of public and private financing of medical research across diseases, by combining over twenty years of private sector clinical trials and projects funded by the National Institutes of Health (NIH), the world’s largest biomedical research funder. Using supervised machine learning tools, we map trials and projects to their respective diseases. Our findings reveal that the private and public sectors act as imperfect substitutes. Specifically, the U.S. private sector is less likely to invest in research on diseases that predominantly affect Black Americans—even after accounting for demand and supply determinants of innovation such as disease burden, research opportunity, and potential market size. In contrast, NIH prioritizes these diseases but does not fully compensate for the private sector’s under-investment: on average, NIH funding offsets approximately 80% of the “missing” private sector trials, with significant variation across diseases. We emphasize the importance of policies that incentivize increased private sector investment in diseases disproportionately affecting minorities, as such efforts could significantly reduce existing racial disparities.

“Supply-Side Incentives for Medical Technology Adoption”

I provide novel evidence that physicians respond to changes in insurance reimbursement for in-office treatments, though responses vary and can be unexpected. To estimate physician elasticity to private insurance reimbursement, I exploit a plausibly exogenous regulatory change in Medicare payment. Specifically, I document how private reimbursement typically follows Medicare reimbursement (Clemens and Gottlieb, 2016; Chan and Dickstein, 2019) and use the estimated payer-specific relationship between the two prices to construct a valid instrument. My findings show that supply generally exhibits a positive slope—lower reimbursement reduces treatment provision. However, for certain discretionary treatments, the supply curve is negatively sloped. I provide suggestive evidence that physicians compensate for reduced reimbursement by increasing provision of these and related treatments that can be easily combined in single patient visits.

Work in Progress

“Cost-Plus Reimbursement Contracts and Healthcare Market Segmentation”
(with J. Wang)

Teaching

Graduate Level (NYU Stern):

Industrial Organization, TF for Prof. Chris Conlon, Luís Cabral, Giulia Brancaccio — Spring 2023, 2025

PhD Math Camp, Instructor — Summer 2024

MBA/EMBA Level (NYU Stern):

Healthcare Markets, TF for Prof. Michael J. Dickstein — Spring 2022

Undergraduate Level (NYU Stern and Bocconi):

Health Economics, TF for Prof. Michael J. Dickstein — Spring 2022

Microeconomics with Algebra, TF for Prof. Luís Cabral — Fall 2021, 2022

Microeconomics, TF for Prof. Maristella Botticini — Fall 2018

Research Experience and Other Employment

Research Assistant for Prof. Guido Tabellini, Bocconi University 2018-2019

Visiting Researcher at IGIER, Bocconi University 2017-2019

Visiting Student at Nunnari Lab for Economic Experiments, Bocconi University 2016-2017

Intern at The Boston Consulting Group (Risk Team), Milan 2017

Honors and Awards

Harold W. MacDowell Prize, awarded to "the PhD graduate who best exemplifies the qualities of and dedication to scholarship" 2025

Center for Sustainable Business research grant ($\$2,500$) 2024

Center for Global Economy and Business research grant ($\$7,000$) 2021

Edwin and Diane Elton Fellowship, NYU Stern 2023-2024

NYU Stern School of Business PhD Fellowship 2019-2023

Conferences and Seminars (* means scheduled)

International Industrial Organization Conference (IIOC, "Rising Stars" session), 3rd Health Economics Conference at TSE*, American Society of Health Economists (ASHEcon)*, European Association for Research in Industrial Economics (EARIE)*, Rochester Simon, Indiana Kelley, UOregon, Stockholm School of Economics, Universidad Carlos III de Madrid 2025

American Society of Health Economists (ASHEcon), San Diego 2024

NBER Health Economics Research Summer Bootcamp, Berkeley 2022

AEA Workshop for Women in Health Economics and Policy, online 2021

NYU and NYU Stern Seminars: Industrial Organization, Applied Micro, Econometrics 2021-2024

Professional Activities

Referee for: *Journal of Health Economics, Journal of Economics and Management Strategy*

Co-organizer: Econometrics Summer Reading Group at NYU Economics Department

Mentor for: PhD and MSc in Quantitative Economics students at NYU

Others

Software and Programming: Python, Stata, LaTeX, GitHub, Bash (Linux)

Languages: English (Fluent), Italian (Native), French (Intermediate)

Citizenship: Italian

Last update: April 2025